Matthieu Meeus

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Work Experience

Research Scientist at Meta *Nov '26-present – NYC, USA*

- Part of the privacy and security team in Fundamental AI Research (FAIR) within Meta Superintelligence Labs (MSL).

Research Scientist Intern at Meta *March-August '26 – NYC, USA*

- Part of Meta Superintelligence Labs (MSL) supervised by Zheng Xu and Luca Melis. Working on training data extraction from models trained on code.

Intern at Microsoft Research *May-August '24 – Cambridge, UK*

- Part of the privacy-preserving machine learning research group, working together with Lukas Wutschitz, Robert Sim and Reza Shokri.
- Researching privacy auditing of synthetic text data generated by LLMs, work published at ICML 2025.

Senior Data Scientist at McKinsey & Company *March '21-July '22 – NYC, USA*

- As part of the People Analytics and Measurement team, I built machine learning models to enhance talent management and organizational effectiveness at McKinsey.
- Leveraged NLP models to improve the matching between applicants and job openings: (i) extracted features from free text resumes to improve the existing candidate ranking model by 10%; (ii) built a 'job-matching' algorithm to detect similar jobs across McKinsey (globally deployed on their website); (iii) built a 'resume-to-job' algorithm, which, given free-text resumes, recommends the top jobs based on your qualifications.
- Built a search engine for transcripts of expert interviews, based on language embeddings and named entity recognition.
- Many ad-hoc projects including NLP for McKinsey projects, prediction of attrition, the composition of ideal teams.

Energy Optimization Intern at Tesla Inc. *May-August '20 – CA, USA*

- Software development for Tesla's Energy Optimization Team, working on optimal battery discharge strategies in Python.
- Simulated the performance of a new solar energy forecasting method (now implemented).
- Built the first parallelized performance tracking algorithm for one of the team's products using Kubernetes and AWS.

Education

Imperial College, London – PhD in Privacy and Security of AI *Oct '22-Sept '26 – London, UK*

- Part of the AI Security and Privacy Lab under supervision of Prof Yves-Alexandre de Montjoye.
- Thesis entitled "Auditing and Understanding Memorization in Large Language Models".
- I contributed to 10+ published papers, including at ICML, Neurips, Nature Communications and Usenix Security.
- Main side-project: fine-tuning LLaMA-2/3 to Dutch (my native language) supported by a grant from the Flemish Super Computer for 40k GPU hours (released here).

Harvard University – M.Sc. in Computational Science & Engineering *Class of '20 – MA, USA*

- Mathematical programming ranging from numerical methods to data science, optimization, computational systems development – GPA 3.85/4.0.
- Teaching Fellow for the core graduate-level course in Advanced Numerical Methods during Fall 2020.
- Fellowship of $100,000 – Belgian American Educational Foundation – Awarded to only 7 students.

University of California, Berkeley – M. Eng. in Mechanical Engineering *Class of '19 – CA, USA*

- One-year master with focus on Energy Technology – GPA 3.98/4.
- Fung Excellence Scholarship – UC Berkeley Fung Institute for Engineering Leadership.

University of Leuven – B.Sc. in Engineering – major Mechanical Engineering *Class of '18 – BE*

- Best of my class after the first year out of more than 500 – Received Best Student Award.

Publications

[1] **Meeus, M.,** Jain, S., Rei, M., & de Montjoye, Y. A. Did the neurons read your book? Document-level membership inference for large language models (USENIX Security 2024).

[2] **Meeus*, M.,** Shilov*, I., Faysse, M., & de Montjoye, Y. A. Copyright Traps for Large Language Models (ICML 2024).

[3] **Meeus, M.**, Shilov, I. , Jain, S., Faysse, M., Rei, M., & de Montjoye, Y. A. SoK: Membership Inference Attacks on LLMs are Rushing Nowhere (and How to Fix It) (SaTML 2025, Best Paper Award).

[4] **Meeus, M.,** Wutschitz, L., Zanella-Beguelin, S., Tople, S. & Shokri R. The Canary's Echo: Auditing Privacy Risks of LLM-Generated Synthetic Text (ICML 2025).

[5] Shilov*, I., **Meeus*, M.,** & de Montjoye, Y. A. The Mosaic Memory of Large Language Models (Nature Communications 2026).

[6] Hayes, J., Shumailov, I., Choquette-Choo, C. A., Jagielski, M., Kaissis, G., Lee, K., ... & Cooper, A. F. Exploring the limits of strong membership inference attacks on large language models (Neurips 2025).

[7] **Meeus, M.**, Shilov, I., Kaissis, G., & de Montjoye, Y. A. Counterfactual Influence as a Distributional Quantity. ICML2025 workshop.

[8] **Meeus*, M.,** Rathé*, A., Remy, F., Delobelle, P., Decorte, J. & Demeester, T. (2024). ChocoLlama: Lessons Learned From Teaching Llamas Dutch. ArXiv preprint.

[9] **Meeus*, M.,** Guepin*, F., Creţu, A. M., & de Montjoye, Y. A. (2023, September). Achilles' heels: vulnerable record identification in synthetic data publishing (ESORICS 2023).

[10] Guépin*, F., **Meeus*, M.,** Creţu, A. M., & de Montjoye, Y. A. (2023, September). Synthetic is all you need: removing the auxiliary data assumption for membership inference attacks against synthetic data (DPM Workshop at ESORICS 2023).

[11] **Meeus, M.,** Jain, S., & de Montjoye, Y. A. (2023). Concerns about using a digital mask to safeguard patient privacy (Nature Medicine 2023).

[12] Guépin, F., Krčo, N., **Meeus, M.,** & de Montjoye, Y. A. (2024). Lost in the Averages: A New Specific Setup to Evaluate Membership Inference Attacks Against Machine Learning Models (DPM Workshop at ESORICS 2023.

[13] Yang, X., Stevanoski, B., **Meeus, M.,** & de Montjoye, Y. A. (2025). Checkpoint-GCG: Auditing and Attacking Fine-Tuning-Based Prompt Injection Defenses. ArXiv preprint.

[14] Krčo*, N., Yao*, Z., **Meeus*, M.,** & de Montjoye, Y. A. (2026). RAT-Bench: A Comprehensive Benchmark for Text Anonymization. ArXiv preprint.

[15] **Meeus, M.,** Ramakrishna, A., Grange, M., Xu, Z., & Melis, L. (2026). Detecting Functional Memorization in Code Language Models. ArXiv preprint.

[16] Chew, D. H. L., Yao, Z., Krčo, N., **Meeus, M.**, Obeidy, W. K., & de Montjoye, Y. A. Localizing Text Anonymization for Trustworthy AI: Extending RAT-Bench to Malaysian Microdata and PII. In Trustworthy AI for Good (AI4GOOD) Workshop @ ICML 2026.